

Ballast — video production plan

A shot script for a filmed pitch: a presenter on camera, short drama beats from real student life, keyword graphics, and the product doing the thing.

Target 4:30

Hard limit 5:00

13 scenes

~610 spoken words

4 locations · 1 shoot day

On the reference video. The link resolves to [UMami Weboosta UM Hackathon 2026.m4v](#) on Google Drive, which needs sign-in to play — so this plan is built from *your* description of the style rather than from that film: **a person pitching on camera, keyword text on screen, and short dramatised scenes**, instead of a narrated slideshow. Watch it yourself before the shoot and steal anything specific you like; the scene table below is structured so you can swap a shot without touching the timings.

The format, and why it scores

Three ingredients, cut against each other so the video never sits still for more than about twenty-five seconds.

INGREDIENT	SHARE	WHAT IT IS DOING FOR THE RUBRIC
DRAMA	~55s	Engagement (2%) and the front half of Clarity (5%) . Wordless or lightly narrated scenes of a student doing the exact thing the app fixes. The panel recognises themselves before you explain anything.
PRESENTER	~95s	Delivery and confidence (4%) . You cannot score this with a voice-over alone — the marker needs to see a face, eye contact and energy. Four pieces to camera, top and tail included.
DEMO	~120s	Clarity and the feasibility half of the argument. The app working, narrated by the presenter in voice-over.

DRAMA 0:16	PRESENTER 0:24	DEMO 0:26	D	DEMO	PRES	D	DEMO	D+DEMO	MONTAGE	D	PRESENTER	CLOSE
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Longest single block is 30 seconds. That rhythm is deliberate — it is what stops a four-and-a-half minute video feeling like eight.

Who and where

Cast — three people is enough

- **PRESENTER.** Your most confident speaker. On camera in scenes 2, 6, 12, 13 and in voice-over throughout. **Same outfit all day** — the four pieces get cut together.
- **STUDENT A.** The drama lead. **No dialogue at all**, so cast whoever is most relaxed on camera, not the best talker.
- **FRIENDS B & C.** Two extras, on screen for about eight seconds total. Any teammates.

Locations — four, all on campus

- **DESK / BEDROOM, night.** Scenes 1, 9. Needs a lamp, a laptop, clutter.
- **LIBRARY or study room, day.** Scenes 4, 7.
- **OUTDOOR or plain wall, day.** Scenes 2, 6, 13 — all the presenter pieces. Pick somewhere quiet.
- **LAPTOP / desk, day.** Scene 12. Scene 11 is a corridor or café.

Kit. A phone on a tripod shoots this fine in 1080p. What actually matters: **the microphone** — record narration separately, indoors, into phone earbuds or a cheap lav, never the on-camera mic outdoors. And **daylight on the presenter's face**: stand facing a window, or with the sun behind the camera.

The shooting script

Every scene states **who** is in it, **where** it is shot, **what** happens and **how** to frame it. **Red** is the exact beat that must land on the cut.

TIME	WHAT / HOW / WHO / WHERE	SAY	ON SCREEN
0:00 16s DRAMA	WHAT — Sunday, 1:47am. STUDENT A at a messy desk. Blank document. Phone buzzes with a group chat. They open a to-do app: "3 tasks today." They close it and stare at the ceiling. HOW — Four shots, ~4s each. Close on the clock · over-shoulder on the blank doc · close on the phone · a wide of them not moving. Handheld is fine, even good. WHO — STUDENT A. No dialogue. WHERE — Desk / bedroom, lights low.	<i>First six seconds: no narration. Room tone only.</i> "It's Sunday night. Your planner says three tasks. What it doesn't say is that one of them is a group presentation you've been dreading all week."	SUNDAY · 01:47 bottom-left, first 3s 3 tasks today as a graphic over the phone
0:16 24s PRESENTER	WHAT — First piece to camera. Introduce yourself, name the flaw, name the product. HOW — Mid-shot, chest up, presenter slightly off-centre with space on the lens side. Eyes on the lens, not the screen. Cut to a two-second insert of a laundry basket and a lecture theatre on "an hour of laundry". WHO — PRESENTER. WHERE — Outdoor / plain wall, daylight.	"Hi — I'm [NAME]. And that's the problem with every planner ever made: they count hours. An hour of laundry is not an hour of a group presentation. So two weeks can look completely identical — and one of them quietly breaks someone. This is Ballast. The first planner that measures what a task actually costs you."	EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS BALLAST as a title card on the name
0:40 26s DEMO	WHAT — The core claim, demonstrated. /welcome . HOW — Screen recording in a phone frame. Drag the dread dots on the presentation up to 4 while speaking; let the bars visibly swap before the next line. Hold two seconds on the result. WHO — PRESENTER in voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture, recorded separately.	"One idea. Load equals time times dread. Three hours of a presentation you're dreading. Six hours of reading you enjoy. Drag the dots — and the three-hour task overtakes the six-hour one. Half the hours. Twice the load. Every screen in this app is downstream of that one multiplication."	load = time × dread large, centred, held 4s HALF THE HOURS. TWICE THE LOAD.
1:06 10s DRAMA	WHAT — A group project meeting. STUDENT A nodding along, visibly flat. B and C talking over each other. A checks the time. HOW — One slow push-in on A's face while the others move. Sound: muffled chatter, ducked under the VO. WHO — STUDENT A, FRIENDS B & C. WHERE — Library / study room.	"But dread isn't one thing. That presentation costs your head, your evenings, and a chunk of social energy you never thought to count."	HEAD HOURS SOCIAL appearing one at a time on the beats
1:16 24s DEMO	WHAT — Capture. /add → tap Assignment → Next → Next. HOW — On page three, drag Mental up, then Time, then Social — slowly. The faces changing expression is the single most charming thing in the app; give it room. Zoom the edit in ~15% on the dial row. WHO — PRESENTER in voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"So when you add something, you don't pick a number one to five. You drag five faces — head, hours, body, social, admin — and the more you push, the more overwhelmed they look. Nobody has to learn a scale. You can read the faces without reading the labels."	ONE TASK · FIVE AREAS

1:40 18s PRESENTER	WHAT — Presenter holds the actual phone up and turns it to the lens. HOW — Mid-shot, then cut to a clean screen recording for the numbers so they are legible. Point at Mental 35 and Physical 83 on the words. WHO — PRESENTER, on camera. WHERE — Outdoor / plain wall. Same setup as scene 2.	"And that gives you this. Forty-seven percent left — and underneath, which part of you is actually empty. My head's at thirty-five. My body's at eighty-three. That pairing has a fix. One number on its own doesn't."	47% LEFT MENTAL 35 · PHYSICAL 83
1:58 10s DRAMA	WHAT — STUDENT A adds a third sticky note to a wall planner. All three land in the same week. They step back and go still. HOW — Close on the hand and the notes, then a wide as they step back. The third note lands on the VO word "seventy-two". WHO — STUDENT A. WHERE — Library / bedroom wall.	"And here's what actually ruins a semester. It's never the total — it's three deadlines landing in the same seventy-two hours."	IT'S NOT THE TOTAL. IT'S THE PILE-UP.
2:08 28s DEMO	WHAT — /plan , then /rebalance . HOW — Hold on the collision card. Cut to Rebalance; toggle two trades and let the percentage climb on screen. Then tap the locked Group presentation row so the panel watches it refuse. That refusal is the most persuasive two seconds in the whole video — do not rush it. WHO — PRESENTER in voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"So Ballast slides a seventy-two-hour window across your fortnight and flags density, not volume — and it tells you eight days out. Long enough to email a tutor or swap a shift. Then it prices what you could put down. Toggle, and the battery moves live. Now try the group presentation. You can't. Hard deadlines are locked — because an app that suggests skipping your exam is an app you stop trusting."	WARNED 8 DAYS EARLY 41% → 50% counting up with the toggles LOCKED on the refusal
2:36 22s DRAMA DEMO	WHAT — STUDENT A types a message, deletes it. Types it again, deletes it. Puts the phone face-down. Cut hard to the drafter writing it instantly. HOW — Tight over-shoulder on the phone screen, real typing. Three takes of type-and-delete, cut fast. The hard cut to the app is the joke — land it clean. WHO — STUDENT A, then screen capture of /decline/w11-birthday . WHERE — Desk / bedroom, night.	"Knowing what to cut was never the hard part. [type... delete... type... delete] Writing the message is. Four days of drafting a text you never send. So Ballast writes it. Three tones. You edit it. And it never sends anything."	DAY 1 DAY 2 DAY 3 stamping on each delete IT NEVER SENDS ANYTHING
2:58 30s DEMO	WHAT — Montage of three features, ~10s each. HOW — 1 · Home scrolled to Owing: press "Book 3 sittings for me". 2 · /actions : drag one slider. 3 · /priority : scroll so the reason chips read. Lift the music here; this is the pace peak. WHO — PRESENTER in voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"Three more, quickly. Assignments stop hiding until the night before — they sit on every day, and this books your study sittings across your lightest days automatically . Your evening gets planned around what <i>you</i> actually do — add badminton, it becomes a permanent slider. And when you've got twelve things: one ranked list. Deadline, who you promised, and whether it can even still be finished ."	IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS YOUR HOBBIES, NOT OURS WHAT TO DO FIRST

3:28
12s

DRAMA

WHAT — Split screen. STUDENT A types "you free this week?" and deletes it. On the other side, FRIEND B does exactly the same. **Cut to the friends screen showing everyone's battery.**
HOW — Two phone screens, same framing, side by side in the edit.
WHO — STUDENT A and FRIEND B.
WHERE — Corridor / café, and screen capture of /areas/social .

"Nobody sees their friends in week ten because everyone assumes everyone else is busier.

Now you can see **who actually has room** — a band, never a number."

"you free this week?"

then struck through

A BAND,
NEVER A
NUMBER

3:40
28s

PRESENTER

WHAT — Feasibility. Presenter beside a laptop, turns the screen towards the lens.
HOW — Start on the presenter, then cut to three inserts: the live URL being typed · the architecture diagram from README §5.2 · **a sped-up recording of npm run preflight finishing green.** Record that terminal run beforehand and play it at 4x.
WHO — PRESENTER, on camera.
WHERE — Laptop / desk, daylight.

"It's **Expo and React Native** — one codebase, iOS, Android and web. It's live right now: no install, no sign-in.

Everything runs **on the phone**. No server, no network. The scheduler is a real algorithm, not a language model — which is why it still works on a bus with no signal.

And none of this is a mock-up. **Three hundred and thirteen** automated checks prove every button does what it claims."

iOS · ANDROID ·
WEB

WORKS
OFFLINE

313
AUTOMATED
CHECKS

on the green
terminal

4:08
22s

PRESENTER

WHAT — The close. Straight to camera, no cutaways until the last line.
HOW — Step **half a metre closer** than scene 2 so the frame is tighter — it reads as conviction. Slow down. On the final line, cut to STUDENT A from the cold open, now closing the laptop and turning the lamp off.
WHO — PRESENTER, then STUDENT A.
WHERE — Outdoor / plain wall, then desk.

"Three weeks after finals, we add accounts and sync. That's the only thing it can't already do on its own.

Every wellbeing app tells a drowning student to *breathe*. **Ballast tells them which three things to put down** — and writes the awkward message for them.

Ballast. The weight you carry on purpose, so you don't capsize."

3 WEEKS TO
SYNC

End card, held 3s in
silence:

BALLAST

load-balancer-
ballast.expo.app

Shot list, grouped by location

Shoot in this order, not script order — it is one day instead of three.

BLOCK	SCENES	WHO	SHOTS TO GET
A · Outdoor / wall daylight, ~40 min	2, 6, 13	Presenter	All three presenter pieces back to back. Two takes minimum of each. Scene 13 framed tighter than scene 2. Also grab 10s of the presenter silent and smiling, for a cutaway safety net.
B · Desk, night lamp only, ~30 min	1, 9, 13 end	Student A	Clock close-up · blank doc over-shoulder · phone buzzing · wide of stillness · three type-and-delete takes · laptop closing and lamp off.
C · Library daylight, ~20 min	4, 7	A, B, C	Group meeting push-in on A's face · hands adding sticky notes to a wall planner · wide of A stepping back.
D · Corridor / café ~10 min	11	A, B	Two matching over-shoulder shots of typing and deleting the same message.
E · Screen capture no cast, ~30 min	3, 5, 8, 9b, 10, 11b	—	/welcome dread drag · /add to page three · /plan · /rebalance toggles and the locked row · /decline/w11-birthday tone switch · Owing "Book 3 sittings" · /actions slider · /priority scroll · /areas/social . Plus a terminal run of npm run preflight .
F · Narration indoors, quiet, ~20 min	all	Presenter	Record the entire script as voice-over in one sitting, including the lines said on camera. Gives the editor a clean fallback for any line where the sync sound is poor.

Before any of it: open the app → **Areas** → **Reset to the seeded week**, and confirm Home reads **47%**. Every number spoken in this script comes from that state. If it says something else, the reset did not take.

Keyword graphics

Fifteen text cards. Keep one font, one weight, one position per type — motion should be a simple fade or a 6-frame slide up, nothing spinning.

Full-screen — held 3–4s, on a colour panel

load = time × dread

BALLAST

ONE TASK · FIVE AREAS

313 AUTOMATED CHECKS

Lower third — over footage, 2s

EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS

IT'S NOT THE TOTAL. IT'S THE PILE-UP.

WARNED 8 DAYS EARLY

IT NEVER SENDS ANYTHING

A BAND, NEVER A NUMBER

Pinned to the screen — tracks the UI

47% LEFT

MENTAL 35 · PHYSICAL 83

41% → 50%

LOCKED

IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS

WHAT TO DO FIRST

Plus full subtitles throughout. Assume part of the panel watches muted. Burn them in — YouTube auto-captions corrected by hand is fine.

Edit and performance

Assembly order

- Lay the **full narration** down first, end to end, and trim it to 4:20. This is your spine.
- Drop the four presenter pieces onto their lines, sync by waveform.

Performance

- Smile on the first line of scene 2.** It is audible and it buys you the whole opening.
- Eyes on the lens**, never on your own preview. This is the single biggest tell of a nervous pitch.

3. Fill the gaps with demo capture. Speed screen recordings to **1.2x** — UI always plays slower than it feels.
4. Cut the drama in last, to the beat.
5. Music: one instrumental bed, low. Lift it at 2:58 for the montage, drop it out completely under the final line.

- **Slow on numbers:** "forty-seven percent", "eight days out", "three hundred and thirteen".
- **Land the jokes and move on.** No pause for a laugh that isn't in the room.
- **Scene 13 is slower and quieter** than everything before it. Conviction, not volume.
- Fluffed a line? Re-say it cleanly and keep rolling. Fixing it in the edit costs eight seconds; re-shooting costs ten minutes.

If the cut lands over 4:50 — trim in this order

1. **Scene 11, friends (–12s)** — the only scene nothing else depends on.
2. **Scene 1, cold open (–5s)** — start on the blank document instead of the clock.
3. **Scene 10, drop Tonight (–10s)** — keep Owing and Priority; they are the stronger pair.
4. **Scene 4 (–5s)** — hold on A's face for two seconds instead of four.

Never cut: the dread drag (0:40), the five dials (1:16), the locked deadline (2:08), or "313 automated checks" (3:40). Those four carry Clarity, Novelty and Feasibility between them.

Five ways teams lose Presentation marks

1. **Running over.** 5:01 is a scored penalty. Export, watch it, check the runtime.
2. **Explaining the ideation.** That is marked from the README. Here it is a minute you cannot afford.
3. **Narrating the UI.** "Now I click here..." — say what it *means*; let the screen show the click.
4. **Slides with no product.** You have a live app and nearly half of this is it working. That is the advantage.
5. **Trailing off.** End on the line and the held card. No "...so, yeah, thanks for watching."